

Word family: **cover / covers / covered / covering / coverage / uncovered / uncover**

Base word: cover

Forms: covers, covered, covering

Related forms: coverage, uncovered, uncover

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “...several tables have already been turned into mini-classrooms **covered in notes, pens and past papers**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **covered in** means **having many things spread over or occupying most of a surface**.

The tables have notes, pens, and past examination papers all over them.

繁體中文： **鋪滿；擺滿；表面到處都是**

中文翻譯：

> “...mini-classrooms **covered in notes, pens and past papers**.”

「.....變成小型課室，桌面上**擺滿了筆記、筆和歷屆試題**。」

Here:

a table covered in papers = 桌面上到處 / 大部分位置都是紙張

1. **cover = put something over a surface / be spread over it (覆蓋) — 覆蓋；遮蓋；鋪滿**

This is the exact passage branch.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The tables were **covered in** notes and past papers.”

「桌面上**鋪滿了**筆記和歷屆試題。」

Practice 2

> “Snow **covered** the road.”

「積雪**覆蓋了**道路。」

Practice 3

> “She **covered** the food with a cloth.”

「她用布把食物**蓋起來**。」

cover = 令某物的表面被另一種物件、物質或材料遮住 / 鋪滿

Common:

* cover something with a cloth

* be covered in dust

* be covered with snow

* cover the floor

* cover the table

2. **covered in / covered with = 表面滿是.....**

Both are common.

covered in

often sounds especially natural for something extensively spread over a surface:

> covered in mud

> covered in notes

> covered in paint

covered with

can also describe a surface with something on it:

> covered with snow

> covered with flowers

There is substantial overlap; the distinction is not rigid.

3. **cover = hide or protect by putting something over it (遮掩 / 保護) — 蓋住 ; 遮住 ; 保護**

Practice 4

> “She **covered** her face with her hands.”

「她用雙手**遮住**臉。」

Practice 5

> “Cover the plants at night to protect them from frost.”

「晚上把植物**蓋好**，防止霜凍。」

Here the important idea is not merely that something occupies the surface, but that the covering provides:

* concealment

* protection

* warmth

* privacy

This remains closely related to Meaning 1.

4. **a cover** = something placed over another thing (名詞) — 蓋；套；罩；封面

A **cover** can be the object that covers or protects something.

Practice 6

> “Put the **cover** back on the container.”

「把容器的**蓋子**蓋回去。」

Practice 7

> “The book has a bright red **cover**.”

「這本書有一個鮮紅色的**封面**。」

Practice 8

> “We put a protective **cover** over the sofa.”

「我們在梳化上加了一個保護**套**。」

Depending on the object:

* book cover = 封面
* seat cover = 座套
* protective cover = 保護罩 / 套
* cover for a container = 蓋

5. **cover = shelter/protection from danger or weather (掩護 / 遮蔽) — 掩護 ; 遮蔽物**

A major noun extension.

Practice 9

> “The soldiers took **cover** behind a wall.”

「士兵躲到牆後**掩護**自己。」

Practice 10

> “We ran for **cover** when the rain started.”

「下雨後，我們跑去找地方**避雨**。」

take cover = 到安全 / 有遮蔽的地方躲避危險或天氣

This is distinct enough from a literal lid/cover to surface separately.

6. **cover = protect or guard someone/something (保護 / 掩護) — 掩護 ; 保護 ; 看守**

Practice 11

> “I’ll **cover** you while you cross the road.”

「你過去時我會**掩護 / 照應**你。」

Practice 12

> “The defender moved across to **cover** his teammate.”

「防守球員移過去**協防 / 補位**。」

In military/police contexts:

> “Cover me!”

= **掩護我！**

In sport, **cover** can mean guard an opponent, space, or teammate.

7. **cover = include or deal with a subject (內容) — 涵蓋；涉及；講授**

A very major modern sense.

Practice 13

> “The course **covers** basic economics.”

「這門課程**涵蓋**基礎經濟學。」

Practice 14

> “We have already **covered** this topic.”

「我們已經**講過 / 處理過**這個課題。」

Practice 15

> “The report **covers** five major issues.”

「這份報告**涵蓋**五個主要議題。」

****cover a topic = 把該課題納入討論、教學、研究或文件內容之中****

Common:

- * cover a topic
- * cover a chapter
- * cover material
- * cover all aspects
- * cover a range of issues

8. **cover = report on an event or issue as a journalist/media organization (新聞) — 採訪；報道**

Practice 16

> “Several reporters were sent to **cover** the event.”

「幾名記者被派去**採訪 / 報道**這次活動。」

Practice 17

> “The newspaper **covered** the story extensively.”

「這份報章廣泛**報道**了這宗新聞。」

cover a story/event = 收集資料並向公眾報道某事件

This developed from the broader “deal with a subject” sense but is conventional enough to surface separately.

9. **coverage** = 報道；涵蓋程度

The noun **coverage** is highly important.

News coverage

> “The incident received extensive media **coverage**.”

「事件獲得廣泛的媒體**報道**。」

Subject coverage

> “The book provides broad **coverage** of the topic.”

「這本書對該課題的**涵蓋範圍**很廣。」

So **coverage** can mean either the act/extent of reporting or the extent to which something is dealt with.

10. **cover** = extend over an area or distance (範圍 / 距離) — 覆蓋；遍及；走過

Practice 18

> “The forest **covers** several square kilometres.”

「這片森林**覆蓋**數平方公里。」

Practice 19

> “We **covered** twenty kilometres on foot.”

「我們徒步**走了**二十公里。」

Practice 20

> “The sales team **covers** the whole region.”

「這個銷售團隊**負責 / 服務**整個地區。」

This branch can describe:

- * physical area
- * distance travelled
- * territory served/responsible for

The underlying concept is **extent or range**.

11. **coverage = service availability over an area (網絡 / 服務) — 覆蓋範圍**

Especially telecommunications:

- > mobile coverage
- > network coverage
- > signal coverage

Practice 21

> “Mobile **coverage** is poor in this area.”

「這個地區的流動網絡**覆蓋 / 訊號覆蓋**很差。」

This belongs to the geographic/range branch.

12. **cover = be enough to pay for something (費用) — 足以支付 ; 支付**

A major financial sense.

Practice 22

> “The fee should **cover** the cost of materials.”

「這筆費用應該足以**支付**材料成本。」

Practice 23

> “Her salary barely **covers** her rent.”

「她的薪金僅僅足以**支付**租金。」

cover a cost = 金額足以應付 / 支付某項費用

This is different from **pay**:

> pay the bill = actually make payment

whereas:

> \$100 covers the bill = \$100 is sufficient to pay it.

13. **cover** = protect against financial loss through insurance (保險) — 承保 ; 保障

Practice 24

> “Does the insurance **cover** theft?”

「這份保險是否**承保**盜竊損失？」

Practice 25

> “The policy **covers** medical expenses overseas.”

「這份保單**保障 / 承保**海外醫療費用。」

cover a risk/loss = 保險公司承諾在特定情況下承擔相關財務損失

This is a major distinct business/legal sense.

14. **cover** = insurance protection (名詞) — 保險保障 ; 承保範圍

Especially common in British English:

- > insurance cover
- > medical cover
- > comprehensive cover

Practice 26

- > “The plan provides worldwide medical **cover**.”

「這項計劃提供全球醫療**保險保障**。」

Related **coverage** is extremely common in American English:

- > insurance coverage

= **保險保障 / 承保範圍**

15. **cover** = do someone's work while they are absent (代班) — 頂替 ; 代班 ; 代為處理

Practice 27

- > “Can you **cover** my shift tomorrow?”

「你明天可以替我**代班**嗎？」

Practice 28

- > “I'll **cover** for her while she is away.”

「她不在時我會替她**頂替 / 代為處理工作**。」

This is a major workplace sense.

16. **cover for someone** = protect someone from blame / hide their absence or mistake (替人掩護)

The same construction can have a second nuance.

Practice 29

- > “He asked me to **cover for** him.”

Depending on context:

1. **替他代班**
2. **替他掩飾 / 打掩護**

So context matters.

17. **cover = conceal something embarrassing, secret, or incriminating (隱瞞) — 掩飾 ; 遮掩**

Practice 30

> “He tried to **cover** his embarrassment with a laugh.”

「他試圖用笑聲**掩飾**自己的尷尬。」

Practice 31

> “They attempted to **cover** their tracks.”

「他們試圖**掩蓋**自己的行蹤 / 證據。」

The idea returns to physically putting a cover over something so that it cannot be seen.

18. **cover up = conceal wrongdoing or an embarrassing fact (重要固定延伸) — 掩蓋 ; 隱瞞**

Practice 32

> “The investigation found an attempt to **cover up** the mistake.”

「調查發現有人企圖**掩蓋**這個錯誤。」

Because **cover up** is a phrasal verb, I would normally keep it outside the bare-word core, but it is an important extension of this branch.

19. **cover = false identity or explanation used to conceal secret activity (諜報) — 掩護身分 ; 掩飾**

As a noun:

Practice 33

> “His job at the company was only a **cover**.”

「他在公司的工作只是一個**掩護身分**。」

Common:

- * under cover
- * undercover
- * blow someone's cover
- * maintain a cover
- * cover identity
- * cover story

cover = 用來隱藏真正身分、目的或活動的表面身分 / 解釋

This is a genuinely distinct noun branch.

20. **blow someone's cover** = expose their secret identity (固定表達) — **揭穿身分**

> “The photograph could blow his **cover**.”

「這張照片可能會**揭穿他的秘密身分**。」

Important spy/crime vocabulary.

21. **cover story** = magazine feature OR false explanation (兩種重要意思)

This compound is potentially confusing.

Magazine/media

> **cover story**

= the main story featured on the cover of a magazine

封面故事

Concealment

> a cover story

can also mean a fabricated explanation designed to hide the truth.

****掩飾真相的說法 / 假故事****

Same phrase, two distinct contexts.

22. ****cover = perform/record another artist's song (音樂) — 翻唱****

Practice 34

> “The band ****covered**** an old rock song.”

「這支樂隊****翻唱****了一首舊搖滾歌曲。」

****cover a song = 重新表演 / 錄製原本由另一位歌手或樂隊推出的歌曲****

A major modern entertainment sense.

23. ****a cover = cover version of a song (音樂名詞) — 翻唱版本****

Practice 35

> “Their ****cover**** became more popular than the original.”

「他們的****翻唱版本****比原版更受歡迎。」

Common:

* cover song

* cover version

* cover band

This is a genuinely distinct lexicalized noun sense.

24. ****cover = restaurant/hospitality: one diner or place setting (餐飲專業) — 一位食客 / 一客****

This is particularly relevant to your restaurant passage.

In hospitality, a ****cover**** can mean ****one customer served or one place laid at a dining table****.

Practice 36

> “The restaurant served 120 **covers** at lunch.”

「餐廳午市接待了 120 **位食客 / 客次**。」

Practice 37

> “The dining room has space for fifty **covers**.”

「飯廳可以容納約五十**位食客**。」

This is genuine restaurant-industry vocabulary.

It is **not** the meaning of **covered** in your sentence, but it is worth retaining in a comprehensive entry.

25. **cover charge** = entrance/service charge (娛樂場所) — 入場費；最低消費性收費

A **cover charge** is a fee charged for entering certain:

- * clubs
- * bars
- * entertainment venues

Practice 38

> “There is a \$20 **cover charge** after 9 p.m.”

「晚上九時後需要支付二十元**入場費**。」

This is a lexicalized compound rather than a separate bare **cover** sense.

26. **cover** = buy securities to close a short position (金融) — 回補；平倉

In financial markets:

> **cover a short position**

means buying the asset back to close a position created by selling it short.

Practice 39

> “Short sellers rushed to **cover** their positions.”

「沽空者急於**回補** / 平倉。」

Related:

> short covering

= **空頭回補**

This is a genuine modern specialist sense.

27. **cover** = mark/guard an opponent in sport (體育) — 防守；盯防

Practice 40

> “Who is **covering** their best player?”

「誰在**盯防**他們最強的球員？」

In team sports, **cover** can mean:

- * defend a player;
- * defend an area;
- * provide backup for a teammate.

This can be kept with the broader protect/guard branch.

28. **cover the spread** (體育博彩) — 贏過讓分盤

In sports-betting terminology, a team **covers the spread** if its final result is sufficient relative to the bookmaker's point spread.

This is an established specialist expression, but not part of the general learner core.

29. **I've got you/it covered** = I will take care of it (固定表達) — 我會處理；我包辦

Practice 41

> “Don’t worry about the booking—I’ve got it **covered**.”

「不用擔心預訂，我會**處理好**。」

Practice 42

> “Need someone to work Friday? I’ve got you **covered**.”

「星期五需要人代班嗎？我可以**幫你搞定**。」

The metaphor is:

> all necessary protection/responsibility is already provided.

Very common informal English.

30. **cover all the bases** = deal with every important aspect (固定表達) — 顧及所有方面

Practice 43

> “The checklist helps us **cover all the bases**.”

「這份清單有助我們**顧及所有重要方面**。」

This is an idiom derived partly from baseball.

Related form: **covering**

Covering can be a noun meaning a material/layer placed over something.

Practice 44

> “The floor has a protective **covering**.”

「地板有一層保護**覆蓋物**。」

Common:

* floor covering

* protective covering

* cloud covering (less common than cloud cover)

Related form: **coverage**

Coverage is especially important because it inherits several branches:

news coverage

媒體報道

insurance coverage

保險保障 / 承保範圍

network coverage

網絡 / 訊號覆蓋範圍

topic coverage

內容涵蓋範圍

So **coverage** is independently polysemous and deserves explicit family mapping.

Related form: **uncovered**

Uncovered can mean:

physically not covered

> “His head was uncovered.”

「他的頭部沒有遮蓋。」

not insured

> “The loss was uncovered.”

「這項損失**不受保險保障**。」

revealed/discovered

In many contexts this comes through the verb **uncover**:

> uncover evidence

= **發現 / 揭露證據**

Related verb: **uncover**

Uncover means:

1. remove a covering;
2. discover/reveal something previously hidden.

Practice 45

> “The investigation **uncovered** new evidence.”

「調查**發現 / 揭露**了新證據。」

The figurative development mirrors:

> remove the physical cover → reveal what had been hidden.

Important distinction: **cover vs fill**

In your passage:

> “The table was covered in papers.”

means papers were spread over its surface.

> “The table was filled with papers.”

is usually less natural because a table is a surface rather than a container.

So **cover** describes **surface occupation**.

Important distinction: **cover vs hide**

hide

focuses on making something impossible/difficult to see or find.

cover

can physically place something over it.

- > cover your face with your hands
- > hide your face from the camera

There is overlap in figurative concealment.

Important distinction: **cover vs include**

For topics:

include

simply says something forms part of the whole.

cover

suggests the topic is actually **dealt with, discussed, taught, or examined**.

- > “The course includes economics.”

could merely list it.

- > “The course covers economics.”

means economics is taught/dealt with.

Important distinction: **cover vs report**

In journalism:

report

= communicate news/information.

cover

= follow, investigate, and report on an event or subject as part of journalistic work.

A reporter may **cover** an election and produce many individual **reports**.

Important distinction: **cover vs pay**

pay

= actually give the money.

cover

= be enough to meet the cost, or take responsibility for paying it.

> “I’ll pay the bill.”

> “This amount should cover the bill.”

Different emphasis.

Important distinction: **cover vs insure**

insure

= provide/take out insurance.

cover

= specify what risk, loss, person, or event is protected by the policy.

> insure the car

> policy covers theft

Important distinction: **cover vs replace — workplace**

replace

suggests one person takes another's place, perhaps permanently.

cover

usually suggests temporarily doing their work while they are absent.

> “Can you cover my shift?”

= temporary.

Important distinction: **cover** vs **conceal**

conceal

is more formal and specifically means hide.

cover

has many broader meanings and only sometimes means conceal.

> conceal evidence

> cover your embarrassment

Grammar note: **cover with / be covered in**

Active

> cover the table **with** papers

Passive/result

> the table is covered **in/with** papers

Both are natural.

Grammar note: **cover + topic/event/cost/distance**

No preposition is normally required:

> cover the topic

> cover the election

> cover the cost

> cover 20 kilometres

The meaning changes according to the object.

This is one reason **cover** is such a strong polysemy word.

Countability note

The noun varies by sense.

Protective object

Countable:

> a cover

> two covers

Shelter

Usually uncountable in:

> take cover

Music version

Countable:

> a cover

> several covers

Restaurant diner

Countable:

> 100 covers

Insurance

Usually uncountable:

> insurance cover

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

* **cover**
 * **covers**
 * **covered**
 * **covering**
 * **coverage**
 * **uncovered**
 * **uncover**

Important compounds and constructions include:

* covered in/with
 * book cover
 * take cover
 * cover a topic
 * cover a story
 * media coverage
 * insurance cover/coverage
 * network coverage
 * cover the cost
 * cover a shift
 * cover for someone
 * cover one's tracks
 * cover story
 * blow one's cover
 * cover a song
 * cover version
 * restaurant covers
 * cover charge
 * cover a short position
 * I've got it covered
 * cover all the bases

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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cover — surface	把某物鋪 / 蓋在表面，或使表面大部分被某物佔據
cover — protect/conceal physically	用東西蓋住，以提供保護、遮蔽或隱私
cover — noun object	用來蓋住 / 保護物件的蓋、套、罩、封面等
cover — shelter	躲避危險 / 天氣的掩護或遮蔽
cover — protect/guard	掩護、保護或防守某人 / 地方
cover — topic	把某課題納入講授、討論、文章或研究內容中
cover — journalism	採訪並報道某事件 / 新聞
cover — area/distance	延伸 / 覆蓋某範圍；走過某段距離；負責某地區
cover — cost	金額足以支付 / 應付某項費用

cover — insurance	承保某種風險、損失或費用	
cover — substitute	暫時替別人代班 / 代為工作	
cover — conceal	掩飾、隱瞞某事實、行蹤或情緒	
cover — secret identity	為隱藏真實身分 / 目的而使用的掩護身分或故事	
cover — music	翻唱另一位歌手 / 樂隊原有的歌曲	
cover — hospitality	餐飲業中一位食客 / 一客	
cover — finance	買回資產以結束沽空倉位；回補	
coverage	報道、保險保障、網絡覆蓋或內容涵蓋範圍	
uncover	移除遮蓋；進一步引申為揭露 / 發現隱藏事物	

For your original sentence

> “...mini-classrooms **covered in notes, pens and past papers**.”

The exact meaning is:

covered in = 桌面的大部分空間都被筆記、文具和歷屆試題佔滿 / 鋪滿

So:

> **tables covered in notes**

= **桌面上鋪滿 / 擺滿筆記**

There is no idea of protection or concealment here. It is the **surface-distribution** sense.

For your database, I would count **10 genuinely useful core meanings** for **cover**:

1. **place/spread something over a surface**
2. **protect, shelter, or guard**
3. **noun: protective layer/object/shelter**
4. **include or deal with a topic**
5. **journalistically report an event/subject**
6. **extend across an area/distance or service territory**
7. **meet/pay a cost or provide insurance protection**
8. **temporarily substitute for someone**
9. **conceal or provide a secret cover identity**
10. **perform another artist's song / noun cover version**

Then I would keep **restaurant cover = one diner**, **finance cover = close a short position**, and sports-marking uses as established domain branches, while giving **coverage** its own strong family treatment because its news, insurance, network, and scope meanings are all common.